

# The Length of Dementia

Ten things families should know. Dementia is a journey, not a stopwatch — every person's path is unique.

*Behind every person with dementia is a story, a soul, and someone who still matters deeply.*

- 1 NOT A TIMELINE**  
No doctor can predict exactly how long someone will live with dementia.
- 2 MANY LIVE FOR YEARS**  
Some live 10, 15, or even 20 years, especially with early diagnosis and strong support.
- 3 TYPE MATTERS**  
Alzheimer's, Lewy body, vascular, and frontotemporal dementia can progress differently.
- 4 OVERALL HEALTH MATTERS**  
Heart disease, diabetes, infections, and frailty often influence outcomes more than dementia itself.
- 5 FALLS CAN CHANGE THE COURSE**  
Preventing injuries and avoiding unnecessary hospital stays can make a significant difference.
- 6 SOCIAL CONNECTION MATTERS**  
People who stay engaged with family, music, faith, and purpose often do better.
- 7 NUTRITION & HYDRATION MATTER**  
Weight loss and dehydration are common challenges that can affect health and function.
- 8 SLEEP IS BRAIN CARE**  
Poor sleep can worsen confusion, mood, and overall well-being.
- 9 QUALITY OF LIFE MATTERS MOST**  
The goal is not simply more days. The goal is meaningful days.
- 10 LOVE OUTLASTS MEMORY**  
Even as names fade, people often still respond to kindness, comfort, and the feeling of being loved.

*"Perhaps the better question is not, 'How much time do we have?' but rather, 'How can we make the time we have meaningful?'"*

BE PATIENT

BE KIND

BE PRESENT

*Life happens. Best have a plan.*

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